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AFRICA'S SACRED HEALING PLANT · AN INTRODUCTION

Iboga *& You*

An honest, grounded introduction to iboga, what it is, where it comes from, what it heals, and what it asks of you.

Tabernanthe iboga

PREPARED BY VITAL KAUA'I
KAUA'I, HAWAI'I · 2026
FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This Guide Is *For You*

Iboga is often spoken about in the context of deep healing and personal transformation. That conversation matters, and it reaches only a fraction of what this plant offers. The people most called to work with iboga at Vital Kaua'i tend to recognize themselves here.

Feeling the ceiling

Life is good on the surface, and something essential is still missing. A sense of living below your full capacity, circling the same patterns, knowing there is more.

Anxiety & depression

Carrying weight that conventional approaches have partially addressed. A readiness to go to the root and resolve it completely, and to come home to yourself on the other side.

Loops ready to break

Relational patterns, ways of thinking, coping strategies that once served and have long since run their course. A genuine desire to step out of the story and into something new.

Creative stagnation

Artists, entrepreneurs, and visionaries who sense their deepest creative source has been inaccessible, and who want to reclaim it. Iboga opens channels that have been closed for years.

Coming into alignment

A felt sense that your life as it is and your life as it is meant to be are out of step. A deep pull toward clarity, purpose, and living from a truer version of yourself.

Ready for a real reset

The ordinary tools, therapy, retreats, practices, have moved the needle and a deeper intervention is calling. A willingness to go somewhere most people leave unexplored.

Neurogenesis & cognitive enhancement

Those seeking to sharpen clarity, expand cognitive capacity, and stimulate new neural growth. Iboga is one of the most potent known stimulators of BDNF and GDNF, the brain's primary regenerative proteins, opening a neuroplasticity window that continues deepening for weeks after ceremony.

> *"Imagine waking up on the other side, clearer, freer, more yourself than you have ever been."*
>
> VITAL KAUA'I · THE IBOGA JOURNEY

THE PLANT

What Is *Iboga?*

Iboga, formally known as *Tabernanthe iboga*, is a perennial rainforest shrub native to the equatorial forests of Gabon, Cameroon, and Central West Africa. Its root bark contains a rich constellation of alkaloids that produce profound effects on the human brain, nervous system, and psyche. A whole plant with a living intelligence, it has been worked with by traditional practitioners across hundreds of generations.

At Vital Kaua'i, we work exclusively with whole-plant iboga root bark, the full living intelligence of the plant, titrated consciously and in continuous dialogue with your body. Your ceremony is held in living relationship with the land, water, and forest of Kaua'i's North Shore, nature as active participant.

> *"Iboga gives you what you need, not what you want."*
>
> BWITI SAYING · GABON

The Pygmy tribes of Gabon and Cameroon are widely recognized as the original discoverers of iboga's healing and visionary properties, passing this knowledge to the Bwiti across countless generations. The Bwiti understand the plant as a being, a teacher with intelligence and the capacity to perceive exactly what each person needs. The medicine shows you the truth of your life. The clearer you arrive, the deeper it goes.

WHAT WE WORK WITH

Whole-Plant Root Bark

The full inner bark contains over 12 identified alkaloids working in concert, ibogaine, noribogaine, ibogamine, tabernanthine, and others. Together they create an entourage effect no isolated compound can replicate. The onset is slower, more titrated, and the spirit of the plant arrives whole. This is a deliberate choice rooted in deep respect for the tradition.

FOR CONTEXT

Isolated Ibogaine

The single primary alkaloid extracted from the root bark, used in Western clinical settings, including the landmark Stanford study. Measurable and standardized. We honor this research fully. Its onset is faster and more intense, requiring the highest level of cardiac monitoring. What it carries is the alkaloid. What it leaves behind is everything else the plant holds.

THE TRADITION

Iboga & *The Bwiti*

To understand iboga fully, one must understand the Bwiti, the spiritual tradition within which iboga has been held for centuries as its central sacrament. It is a living tradition of initiation, healing, community, and connection to the spirit world and one's ancestors.

The Bwiti is practiced primarily by the Fang, Mitsogo, and Punu peoples of Gabon and Cameroon. Iboga ceremonies are serious, structured, and held within a rich container of music, ritual, community, and the guidance of trained healers called Ngangas, who spend years or decades working with the plant before guiding others.

Gabon is the only country in the world where iboga is legally protected as national heritage and cultural treasure. The Gabonese government recognizes the Bwiti tradition and iboga's sacred status in law.

Perhaps the most essential thing to understand: the Bwiti experience iboga as a being, a plant teacher with intelligence and intention. It shows the truth of your life. The clearer you arrive, the deeper it goes. The more open your hands, the more the medicine can place in them.

Josh Perdue, co-founder of Vital Kaua'i, was initiated in Gabon in deep relationship with the plant and the people who have carried it for generations. That reverence, for the land, the medicine, and the wisdom traditions that have held iboga across millennia, is woven into everything we do.

We bring this reverence into our work on the North Shore of Kaua'i, allowing African initiatory wisdom to inspire the container while remaining grounded in our own ceremonial path. The ceremony opens around the fire. The medicine meets you in the dark. And the land of Kaua'i holds everything.

> *"Ceremony opens around a sacred fire, drawing on the wisdom of those who have carried iboga for thousands of years, where fire illuminates what is ready to be released and calls in what wants to arrive."*
>
> VITAL KAUA'I · THE IBOGA JOURNEY

THE HEALING

What Iboga *Works On*

Iboga works across the full architecture of the self, neural, somatic, emotional, and spiritual. These are the domains where people experience the most profound and lasting change.

DEPRESSION & ANXIETY

Going to the Root

Participants frequently describe emerging from ceremony with a sense that heavy emotional weight has genuinely lifted, resolved at the root. Many people report a fundamental shift in how they relate to longstanding patterns of heaviness, worry, or disconnection.

NEUROPLASTICITY & REWIRING

The Brain's Reset Window

In the weeks following ceremony, iboga opens a critical window of heightened neuroplasticity, a period when the brain is exceptionally receptive to new patterns, habits, and perspectives. Iboga stimulates BDNF and GDNF, two key brain-repair proteins that drive neural growth and connectivity. This is where lasting change takes root.

LOOPS & PATTERNS

Breaking the Cycle

Iboga surfaces the emotional and psychological patterns driving repetitive behavior, and creates the conditions for them to be directly encountered, processed, and released. People often describe seeing their patterns with clarity and compassion for the first time, and finding them simply lose their grip.

CREATIVITY & PURPOSE

The Source Reopened

Artists, entrepreneurs, and visionaries consistently report that iboga restored access to a creative source they had lost contact with. The medicine dissolves the stories we tell ourselves about what is possible, and in the space that opens, genuine vision returns. Many people describe reconnecting with the self they always were.

SOMATIC HEALING

What Lives in the Body

Iboga reaches into the somatic layer, where unprocessed experience lives in the body, and supports the release of long-held emotional and energetic imprints. This is why we weave somatic support throughout every phase of your journey, before, during, and after ceremony.

ALIGNMENT & CLARITY

Coming Home to Yourself

Perhaps the most universal report from iboga participants: a felt sense of return. A reconnection, to self, to others, to life itself, that those living below their potential describe as profoundly reorienting. The medicine restores the thread back to who you actually are.

THE SCIENCE

What the Research *Shows*

Iboga has attracted serious scientific attention in recent years, and the results emerging from clinical research represent paradigm shifts. What follows is some of the most significant data in the history of plant medicine science, signaling a fundamental change in how medicine understands what is possible for the human brain and nervous system.

The clinical research on iboga stands apart in modern psychiatry, remarkable for the magnitude of its results. These are fundamental shifts in how human beings experience themselves. The study below, led by Stanford neuropsychiatrist Dr. Nolan Williams, has become a landmark in the emerging science of plant medicine.

STANFORD UNIVERSITY · NATURE MEDICINE · 2023

Special Operations Forces Veterans · Treatment-Resistant PTSD & TBI

In a landmark 2023 study published in *Nature Medicine*, Special Operations Forces veterans with treatment-resistant PTSD, traumatic brain injury, or both received iboga-assisted treatment. The outcomes were extraordinary, and the lead researcher's response said everything.

88% average reduction in PTSD symptom severity at one-month follow-up

80% reduction in depression scores across the participant group

↑ Measurable improvement in cognitive performance, suggesting genuine neurological restoration, alongside psychological effects

" *This is the most dramatic thing I have ever seen in a clinical trial.*
— DR. NOLAN WILLIAMS, STANFORD UNIVERSITY SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Dr. Nolan Williams, triple board-certified neuropsychiatrist, Director of the Stanford Brain Stimulation Lab, and the pioneering force behind ibogaine's most significant clinical research, passed away in 2025. His work changed what medicine believes is possible. We honor him here.

Memory *Reconsolidation*

Iboga appears to facilitate memory reconsolidation, the neurological process by which memories, when re-accessed, become briefly malleable and can be restructured. This is why the experience frequently surfaces buried memories in a way that is vivid and yet somehow more workable than before, allowing genuine processing and integration to occur at depth. The memory integrates fully; it loses its charge.

The Research *Landscape*

A 2022 systematic review published in peer-reviewed literature analyzed 24 studies involving 705 participants and found consistent evidence that ibogaine and noribogaine hold significant potential, noting effects on mood, patterns of compulsion, psychological wellbeing, and long-term neurological function.

In 2025, the state of Texas allocated $50 million to fund dedicated clinical ibogaine research, one of the largest public investments in plant medicine science in history.

NORIBOGAINE

The Medicine That Keeps Working

Iboga's primary metabolite, noribogaine, remains detectable in body tissue for 2–3 months post-ceremony, continuing its neurological repair and mood-stabilizing work throughout. It stands singular among plant medicines and psychedelics in this sustained residual mechanism of duration and depth.

BRAIN STATES

The Fetal Brain State

EEG research has documented that iboga produces brainwave patterns characteristic of fetal sleep, the most neuroplastic state the brain ever occupies. Researchers describe this as a recreation of fetal brain states in waking adults, opening a window of neurological possibility that is unprecedented in any known medicine.

DURABILITY · SCHENBERG 2014

Single-Dose, Lasting Change

A clinical study of 75 participants found that a single iboga ceremony shifted the average time free of unwanted patterns from 88 days before ceremony to 299 days after, and 419 days across all sessions. From one experience.

HOW IBOGA DIFFERS

Iboga, Ayahuasca, Psilocybin & *Ketamine*

Interest in plant medicine and expanded states of consciousness is growing rapidly. People often arrive curious about how iboga compares to other medicines they've heard of, and the differences are significant. Understanding them helps you know whether iboga is the right threshold for you.

	IBOGA	AYAHUASCA	PSILOCYBIN	KETAMINE
ORIGIN	Root bark · Central West Africa	Vine brew · Amazon Basin	Mushroom · Global	Synthetic · Lab-derived
DURATION	**12 – 36 hours**	4 – 8 hours	4 – 6 hours	1 – 2 hours
PRIMARY MECHANISM	Multiple receptor systems, serotonin, NMDA, opioid, sigma, dopamine	Serotonin (5-HT2A) via DMT + MAO inhibition	Serotonin (5-HT2A)	NMDA antagonist · dissociative anesthetic
CONSCIOUSNESS	**Fully awake and present, you remain yourself throughout**	The medicine takes you where it chooses, often intense and surrendered	Ego boundaries dissolve, reality reshapes around you	Dissociative, you leave ordinary awareness entirely
INNER EXPERIENCE	Observer of your own life, vivid memories, life review, insight with clarity	Vivid visions, emotional purging, often symbolic and non-personal	Perceptual distortion, mystical states, identity dissolution	Detachment from self and surroundings, dream-like floating
PHYSICAL EXPERIENCE	Ataxia (loss of coordination) and dizziness common; nausea and vomiting possible; lying still is essential throughout, movement worsens symptoms significantly	Nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea ("the purge") are a defining feature; participants can generally sit and move	Mild nausea possible early on; generally physically mobile throughout	Dizziness; reclined but mobile; repeated use can affect the bladder
NEUROPLASTICITY	Deep and extended, weeks of heightened neural growth following ceremony	Present, shorter integration window	Present, multiple sessions often needed	Short-lived, effects require ongoing infusions to sustain

	IBOGA	AYAHUASCA	PSILOCYBIN	KETAMINE
CEREMONY COUNT	Typically one ceremony holds the full arc	Multiple ceremonies over weeks or months	Multiple sessions typically recommended	Ongoing infusions required to maintain effects

THE MOST IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

With iboga, *you remain yourself.*

Ayahuasca, psilocybin, and ketamine each, in their own way, move you away from ordinary consciousness. They dissolve the ego, reshape perception, or carry you somewhere else entirely. The medicine decides where you go.

Iboga is classified by researchers as an **oneirogen**, a substance that produces dream-like states while the person remains fully awake. EEG studies confirm that iboga generates REM-sleep brainwave signatures in waking participants, a neurological phenomenon found in no other known medicine. Psychiatrist Claudio Naranjo coined the term *oneirophrenic state* to describe it: a conscious dreamy state where individuals remain fully open, remember everything, and possess heightened capacity for self-reflection.

Memories surface with extraordinary clarity. You witness your own life as if watching it unfold, alongside archetypal visitations and meetings beyond the self. But throughout all of it, you remain lucid, coherent, and present. Your identity stays intact. You are the observer, clear-eyed, awake, and very much yourself. This is what makes iboga unlike anything else available.

What makes iboga singular is precisely this quality of retained selfhood. You do not lose yourself in the experience, you find yourself in it. The visions and insights feel sovereign and wholly owned.

WHAT SETS IBOGA APART

The physical demands of iboga, the stillness required, the body's effort to metabolize the medicine, the long hours of sustained awareness, are precisely what make it transformative. It is a medicine you meet with your full presence, and one that meets you with equal precision in return.

WHO IT CALLS TO

People who have done the inner work, therapy, meditation, plant medicine, and sense that something deeper remains untouched. People ready to see themselves clearly. People willing to be still for a long time, and to meet what arises with honesty and courage.

HOW WE WORK

The Vital Kaua‘i *Approach*

The medicine shows you the door. We walk through it with you.

The Vital Kaua‘i Iboga Journey begins with six weeks of dedicated preparation for the body, nervous system, and inner landscape, and is followed by your ceremony in week seven. Integration support continues for months afterward. Every phase is held with full guidance and care. You are in ongoing relationship with your care team from the moment you say yes through the full arc of your integration.

Your ceremony is held on the sacred North Shore of Kaua‘i, in living relationship with the mana of the land, the water, and the forest. The medicine we offer is whole-plant iboga root bark, dosed according to your particular constitution and titrated as a slow build in your system rather than a steep onset. Sacred fire, water, music, and ancestral honoring open and hold the container, drawing on the wisdom traditions that have carried this plant for thousands of years.

This work is nature-based, somatic, and psycho-spiritual. We offer a living ceremonial container, held by people who have walked this path themselves, in a place that is itself a healer.

THE JOURNEY ARC

01 WEEKS 1–6 · PREPARATION

Body preparation, dietary protocol, medical screening, daily practices, and preparation calls with your care team.

02 WEEK 7 · KAUA‘I · CEREMONY

Opened at the fire, held in sacred indoor space in harmony with the land. 12–36 hours of deep work with your care team present throughout. Integration in the days that follow happens in nature.

03 MONTHS FOLLOWING · INTEGRATION

The neuroplasticity window. Ongoing calls, somatic support, and the steady work of embodying everything that arose.

GO DEEPER

Podcasts, Films & *Resources*

For those who want to go deeper, these are the resources we recommend most for grounded, thoughtful exploration of iboga and its healing potential.

Podcasts & YouTube

HUBERMAN LAB

Dr. Andrew Huberman with Dr. Nolan Williams
The Stanford PTSD study in depth.
Search: "Huberman Lab ibogaine"

THE DR. HYMAN SHOW

One Dose That Heals Addiction, PTSD, and Brain Injury?
Dr. Mark Hyman and Dr. Nolan Williams on ibogaine's brain-resetting potential.

TIM FERRISS SHOW

Plant Medicine & Veterans
Multiple episodes on iboga with researchers, clinicians, and veterans.
Search: "Tim Ferriss iboga"

KEEPING IT REAL · JILLIAN MICHAELS

The Psychedelic That's Changing Lives
Jillian Michaels and Bryan Hubbard on ibogaine, neuroplasticity, and healing.

IBOGAINE UNCOVERED

Dr. Alejandro Junger: Ibogaine, Neuroplasticity, and Gut Health
Talia Eisenberg with Dr. Junger on the nervous system, gut-brain connection, and ibogaine.

ONE-DEGREE SHIFTS · YOUTUBE

Rooted in Healing: Iboga, Bwiti, and the Path of Transformation
Pascal Tremblay with Troy Valencia, Bwiti initiate and founder of Root & Wisdom.

PSYCHEDELICS TODAY

The Leading Psychedelic Science Podcast
Multiple iboga episodes.
psychedelicstoday.com/podcast

AUBREY MARCUS

Iboga, Plant Medicine & Bwiti Voices
Wide-ranging conversations including voices from within the Bwiti tradition.

Films

DOCUMENTARY · 2014

Ibogaine: Rite of Passage
Traditional Bwiti ceremonial use alongside modern applications. Essential for understanding the cultural roots.

DOCUMENTARY · 2022

Dosed 2: The Trip of a Lifetime
Real individuals through iboga and other plant medicines. Profoundly human and honest.

DOCUMENTARY · 2018

From Shock to Awe
Combat veterans seeking healing through iboga and ayahuasca.

Organizations

MAPS · maps.org

Global Ibogaine Therapy Alliance · globalibogaine.org

VETS · vetsolutions.org

SAFETY & SCREENING

Iboga Asks for *Preparation*

Iboga is a powerful and intelligent plant medicine. It asks to be approached with full preparation, thorough screening, and qualified guidance. This is part of what makes it so effective, and what we take the most seriously.

Every Vital Kaua'i Iboga Journey begins with a thorough review of your health history, current medications, and medical context. We suggest an EKG and electrolyte panel as part of your preparation, what your physician ultimately recommends based on your individual health picture guides the full screening. Our Iboga Preparedness Guide, shared with all enrolled members, walks through this in detail.

Iboga works with the heart, both literally and spiritually. Certain medications require a clearance period before ceremony. Our preparation process ensures you arrive ready, in body, nervous system, and inner landscape.

With proper preparation, qualified facilitation, and a sacred container, iboga's profile is extraordinary. We spare nothing in making sure yours is safe, held, and deeply meaningful.

WHAT WE SUGGEST · YOUR DOCTOR GUIDES THE REST

- EKG, cardiac function and QT interval assessment (suggested)
- Electrolyte panel, potassium and magnesium levels (suggested)
- Full medical review with your physician, additional labs as they advise
- Medication and supplement review, with appropriate clearance periods
- Preparation calls with your care team, intention, readiness, and inner landscape work

→ *Full detail in our Iboga Preparedness Guide, shared with all enrolled members.*

DISCERNMENT

Choosing the *Right Space*

Iboga is a profound and powerful medicine. The container it is held in matters enormously. As interest in iboga grows, so does the range of people offering to hold this work. Some are deeply trained and genuinely called, others are not. Asking clear questions before you commit is an act of self-care and personal integrity.

Safety & Medical Care

A qualified provider requires full medical screening, at minimum an EKG and bloodwork, before your ceremony. Cardiac monitoring should be available throughout. Ask whether a medical professional is on-site or on-call. If a provider tells you medical screening is unnecessary, that is the answer you need.

Experience & Lineage

Ask how long they have worked with iboga specifically, not ibogaine, not other medicines, but this plant. Ask about their training, their lineage, their relationship with the tradition. Ask whether they work with whole-plant root bark or isolated ibogaine. A provider rooted in genuine relationship with this medicine will welcome these questions.

Preparation & Integration

Iboga without preparation and integration is incomplete. Ask what their preparation process looks like and how long it runs. Ask what integration support looks like after you return home. A ceremony is a beginning, what follows is where transformation takes root.

WHAT TO PAY ATTENTION TO

- Pressure to commit quickly
- No preparation process offered
- Large group ceremonies with minimal individual attention
- No medical screening required
- Unwillingness to answer direct questions about safety protocols

KAUA‘I, HAWAI‘I

The Medicine Shows You the Door. *We Walk Through It With You.*

If you feel called, we encourage you to book a discovery session with us through our website.

VITALKAUAI.COM · ALOHA@VITALKAUAI.COM

VITAL KAUA‘I

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This guide is for educational and informational purposes only. It does not constitute medical, legal, or therapeutic advice. Iboga is a powerful plant medicine that requires careful screening and qualified facilitation. Consult a qualified healthcare professional before making any health decisions. Vital Kaua‘i operates as a legally established church, holding medicine work within a sacred and protected religious context.